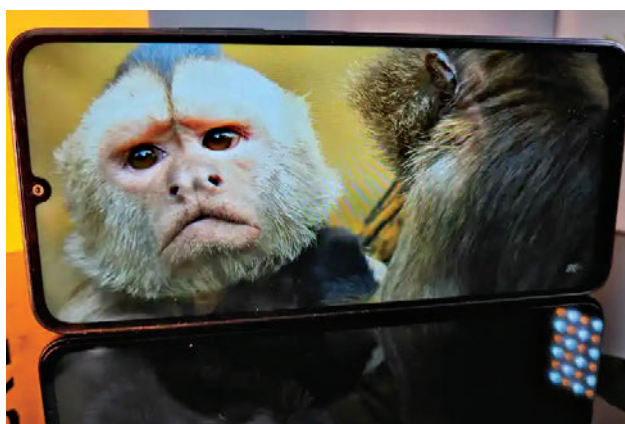
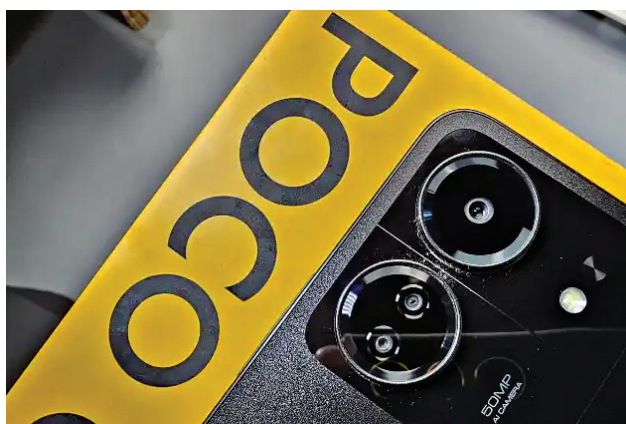




performance is not decent – in fact, it is painfully subpar in 2023.

CAMERAS

POCO has advertised its new C65 as a triple-camera phone, however, there's only really one rear camera that's of any use. The 2 MP macro camera and the 0.08 MP auxiliary camera are just there to boost the numbers. The 50 MP primary camera has an f/1.8 aperture. It captures decent daylight pictures with acceptable dynamic range and a tad bit of oversharpening. Highlights look good, but the shadow areas can get crushed severely.

Indoor photos have quite a bit of grain even with ample lighting and portrait images have subpar edge detection and colour reproduction. The 8 MP selfie camera is passable, but the HDR blooming is intense when there's harsh backlight.

BATTERY LIFE

The POCO C65 houses a 5,000 mAh battery with support for 18 W fast charging. The charging speeds have been boosted

this time around, but not by much. The phone still took a lengthy 2 hours and 31 minutes to charge from empty to full.

The battery life is nothing to write home about as well. The phone lasted close to 8 hours in our 4K video loop test, which is not a great result. It also depleted its battery percentage quicker than competitors when running Google Maps, streaming Netflix, and playing Call of Duty: Mobile. If you're a light user, the POCO C65 may pull through until the end of the day. But if you're not, you're pretty much going to have to charge it around the 4-5 PM mark.

VERDICT

So far, I've come across several budget POCO smartphones that get the blend of features, performance, and affordability right but the POCO C65, sadly, isn't a smash hit. Yes, we are treated to a few improvements such as the 90 Hz display, faster charging, and sleeker body, but the misses are disappointing in the competitive Indian smartphone market. The lack of 5G, when other com-

petitors offer it, is monumental in 2023. I am certain several phones will begin offering 5G starting next year, and the C65 was a great opportunity for POCO to gain a leg up in the game, which they missed out on. At ₹8,499 for the base 4 GB + 128 GB variant, it is a decent option for users who want a basic phone for simple tasks, but that's about it. However, for power users, this is not the play. A great alternative at this price is the Lava Blaze 2 5G. It has similar features with a faster 5G processor.

—Dhriti Datta

SPECIFICATIONS

Processor: MediaTek Helio G85 (12 nm) | GPU: Arm Mali-G52 MC2 | RAM: 4/6/8 GB LPDDR4X | Storage: 128/256 GB eMMC 5.1 | Expandable storage: Yes, up to 1 TB | OS: MIUI 14, Android 13 | Display: 6.74-inch HD+ IPS LCD | Refresh rate: 90 Hz | Rear cameras: 50 MP + 2 MP + 0.08 MP | Front camera: 8 MP | Video: 1080p at 30 fps | Battery: 5,000 mAh | Charging: 18 W wired | Weight: 192 g | Colours: Matte Black, Pastel Blue

CONTACT

Company: POCO | Phone: 1800-572-7626 | Email: service.in@poco.net | Website: <https://www.poco.in/>